

From Variables to Hypotheses

Sociology 310 Discussions, Week 4

Agenda

- Correction: confounder slides from last week
- Questions regarding mediators, moderators, and confounders?
- Group Work - Assignment #2b
- Check Out

Notes

before we begin...

- Any questions / concerns in general?
- Writing Resources:
 - Sweetland Writing Support for Undergraduate Students
 - English Language Institute (ELI) Speaking and Writing Studios

Corrections

A Summary

Analogy + Definition

- Mediators
 - bridge/chain, intermediate Vs explaining the mechanism(s) behind IV influencing DV
- Moderators
 - switch, Vs altering the relationship between IV and DV
- Confounders
 - puppet master, Vs correlated with IV, causing DV, and *not* a mediator

On Confounders...

I need to correct what I said last week!

- puppet master, essentially Vs correlated with IV, causing DV, and *not* a mediator
- “first job (*W*)” not a confounder; both “education (*U*)” and “first job (*W*)” as mediators

- Potential Confounders:

- race/ethnicity? for $X \rightarrow Y$
- academic/cognitive skills?
for $U \rightarrow Y$ in $X \rightarrow U \rightarrow Y$

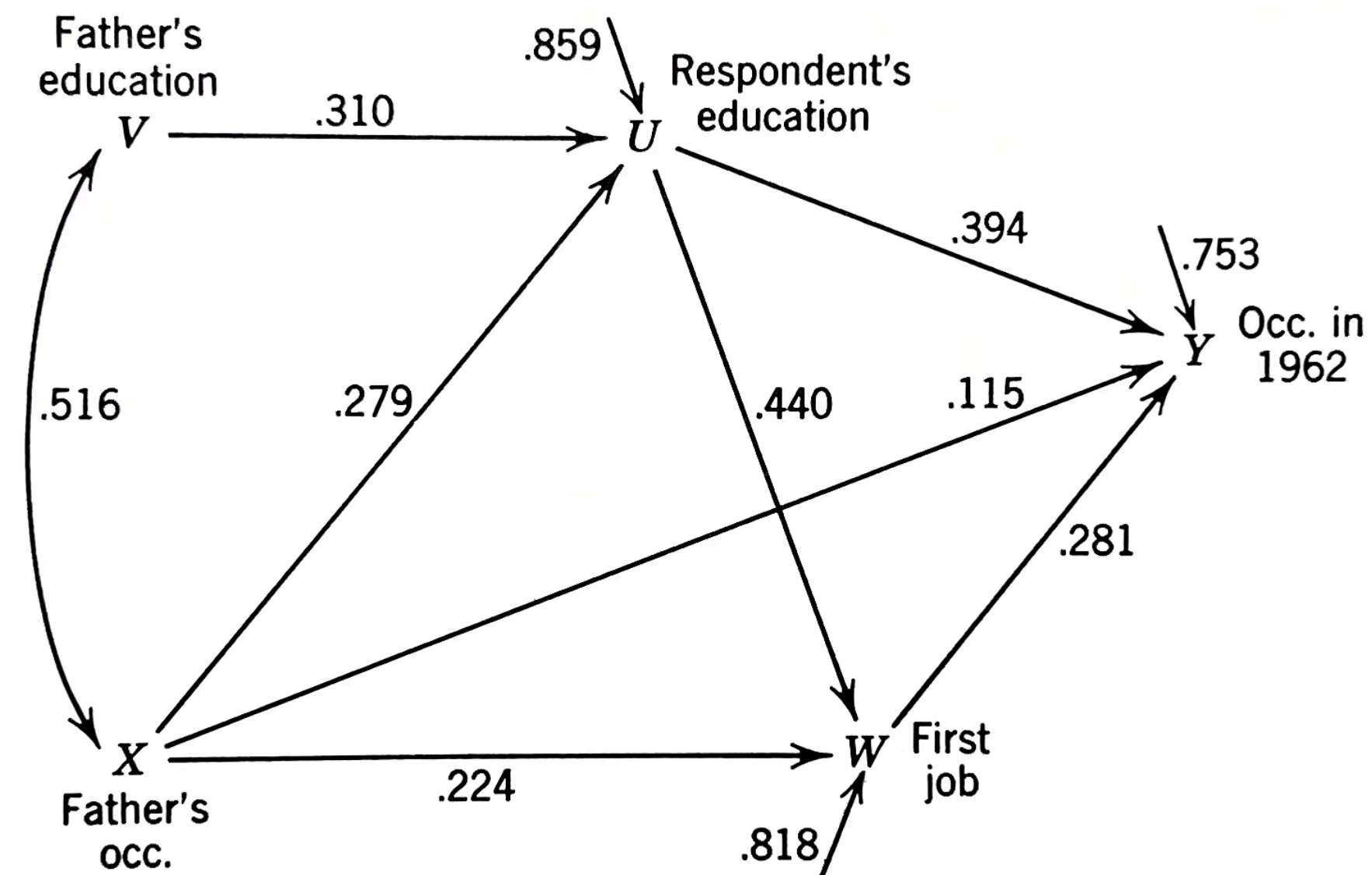


Figure 5.1. Path coefficients in basic model of the process of stratification.

On Confounders...

Two things on which I was right...

- Your goal is to come up with counter explanations -
For your IV-DV causation (with or without mediators), is your IV not causing DV? Rather, they just seem associated? If so, there is a confounder behind the scene. Identify it.
- One variable can be in more than one roles - the types are not mutually exclusive
 - race/ethnicity -
origin-destination association strength differs (e.g., weaker among African Americans)?
 - academic/cognitive skills -
education-destination association strength differs (e.g., stronger for high-skill workers)?

Questions Regarding Variables

Group Work

Assignment #2b

- You should have had a list of variables in your Assignment #2a
- Updates from Assignment #2a:
 - You'll need 8-16 variables
 - You'll need at least 4 mediators and/or moderators

Assignment #2b

- due next Wednesday, Sept. 30
- submit 2 things:
 - your variables + conceptualizations
 - master list as appendix
- will be graded in detail
- *Note: you don't have to cite for everything this time, but I encourage you to cite more*

Check Out

- Please fill in this Check Out Form before you leave
- I will be using this form to track your attendance. This form is also a place where you can share your thoughts, questions, concerns, etc. You can also share your suggestions on how I can improve our sections.
- <https://forms.gle/ipjVD9R1XtyoLgxV8>

